

8.3 File Backup

In *Digit*, we've often emphasised the importance of backing up - so we won't do it again here! You can take backups by manually copying important files to a separate network resource or archiving them to CD or DVD. But a smarter way of achieving the same is using backup software. Such software automates the entire backup procedure, making sure you always have duplicate copies of your important files. Using backup software, you can take backups on a different partition of your hard drive, a different hard drive or on a network resource, or you can move them to an FTP location. There are applications that specifically deal with taking backups on optical media.

Here we review some of the best free tools available for backing up your data.

8.3.1 SyncBack

SyncBack is available in two versions - one free, and the other (SyncBackSE) paid. There are some differences in the feature sets, but the free version has enough features for a typical home user. SyncBack is widely regarded as the best free backup tool available.

Once SyncBack is installed, a wizard prompts for the creation of a new profile. It presents four options - two for backup and two for synchronisation. Using the backup options, you can move your files to another drive or an FTP server, or you can use it to copy files back from an FTP server or Zip file. Smart synchronisation makes it possible to have identical copies of a folder in two different locations.

The UI is simple and self-explanatory. The real power of SyncBack is the amount of customisation it offers; going through each and every option can be a daunting task. To help the matter, you can choose



SyncBag is available both in free and paid versions